

Respect Yourself and Others: Respect-Busting Behaviors, Featuring Doug Buce

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It takes a lot of intentionality, and sometimes a lot of time, to gain the respect of others. But respect-busting behaviors occur daily, and they are committed by everyone at every level. Not intentionally, but out of a lack of awareness. Don't destroy the respect capital you have built for yourself by engaging in these behaviors.

So, what are they? Good question. Here are some of the top respect-busting behaviors.

Gossip. You know when that other team member comes to you and says, 'I shouldn't be telling you, but ...?' Well, we kinda feel good, we're in the *know*. But there's also that part of you that thinks, "What are you saying about me behind my back?" Gossip is team poison.

Hoarding information. Doesn't it drive you crazy when someone has information that can help the entire team, but they keep it to themselves? People may do that because it gives them a sense of power. They want to be relevant. I've got something you don't. Do you want to be relevant? Share the information. Help the team succeed.

Throwing others under the bus. You know, some people walk around the office with a *blame-thrower* on their back. They're not accountable for anything and they will gleefully pull the trigger and torch everybody and everything else. *Not my fault, but yours*. Sometimes, things are your fault. Own it. It may not feel good at the time but it's the professional thing to do. And you will gain respect.

Not being on time. Doesn't it drive you crazy when other people believe their time is more valuable than yours?

Sound bite of Pat Summitt

That word respect can be so powerful. I want you to think about that. Being on time is respect, isn't it?

Video resumes with Doug Buce

Lateness sends a message that you're either too sloppy, too careless, or too special to be on time.

Negativity. We know people commiserate and talk about how bad things are at times but, if you are that person who always starts those conversations, stop it. Negativity kills team morale.

And negativity is like a magnet. After a while, all of those negative people get stuck to each other. They're like a toxic blob that poisons the team. Don't be that toxic person.

And finally, taking credit for others' work. If you've ever been on the receiving end of this, you know how it feels. (If) in front of the boss at a committee meeting that team member says, "I did this, or I found that." It's infuriating because the team did *this* or found *that*. A team that respects each other operates as one.

Don't let these respect-busting behaviors creep into your life. If respecting yourself and others is a priority, become dedicated to modeling appropriate behaviors for your team as well as for others for whom you may be an unknowing role model.